expand at Alexius's expense. In 1109, the king of Jerusalem conquered Tripoli, which gave the Crusaders control of the entire coastline.* Two years later, Bohemund of Antioch died, but his heirs refused to hand Antioch over to Byzantine rule as promised. Alexius Comnenus, occupied with the Turks, did not try to reconquer the "impregnable" city of Antioch, but he never forgave the loss.

And there were new Christian threats to the emperor's power on the horizon, those originating in Italy.



2.1 The Lands of the Crusades

There was no "Italian kingdom." (Italy, remarked the Austrian statesman Metternich in 1814, was only a "geographical expression," a truth that applied to the twelfth century just as well.)[5] The north of the peninsula was ruled by the Holy Roman Emperor Henry V. The center was controlled by Pope Paschal II, head of the Christian Church in the west; the south, by Norman kings. Dotted along the coast were the "maritime republics," Italian cities that controlled coasts and harbors, and which (for all practical purposes) governed themselves. The three most powerful of these were Genoa and Pisa on the western coast, and Venice on the northern end of the Adriatic Sea.

All three had sent soldiers on crusade; all three were now allies of the Crusader kingdoms. Pisan and Venetian and Genoan ships aided the Crusader kings in their territorial struggles against Turks, supplying naval power and an